08-10 第二篇

Developing Critical Thinking Skills

Critical thinking is the ability to analyze information, question assumptions, and form well-reasoned judgments. It is not about criticizing everything or being negative; it is about thinking clearly and independently. In a world full of opinions, ads, and fake news, this skill has never been more important. [1] Critical thinking helps us separate facts from opinions and make better decisions in school, work, and daily life. Learning to think this way takes practice, but the benefits last a lifetime.

One way to develop critical thinking is to ask good questions. [2] Instead of accepting information at face value, ask: Who said this? What evidence supports it? Are there other viewpoints? Questions like these push you to dig deeper and avoid being misled. Teachers who encourage questioning in class help students become more independent thinkers. The habit of asking "why" and "how" is the foundation of critical thinking.

Another important practice is to consider multiple perspectives. [3] When you face a difficult issue, try to understand different sides before forming your own view. Reading articles from various sources, talking to people with different experiences, and playing "devil's advocate" can open your mind. Seeing an issue from several angles does not mean you cannot have strong opinions—it means your opinions will be better informed.

Be aware of your own biases. [4] We all tend to favor information that confirms what we already believe and ignore what challenges us. Recognizing this tendency is the first step toward overcoming it. Ask yourself: Am I agreeing with this because it is true, or because it feels comfortable? Critical thinkers regularly check their assumptions and stay open to changing their minds when the evidence shifts.

[5] Critical thinking is a skill that grows stronger with use. Start small—question one advertisement, fact-check one headline, or debate one topic with a friend. Over time, these habits become natural. In a world that often values quick answers, taking time to think deeply is a powerful advantage.

选项

A. This skill enables us to navigate a world of mixed messages. B. Curiosity and healthy skepticism lead to clearer understanding. C. Exploring different viewpoints strengthens your own judgment. D. Understanding our mental shortcuts helps us think more fairly. E. Building this skill begins with simple, regular practice. F. For example, many employers list critical thinking as a top requirement for new hires.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前指出批判性思维的定义及在信息时代的重要性，空后具体说区分事实与观点、做出更好决策。A项"这项技能使我们能在混杂信息的世界中前行"承上（world full of opinions/ads/fake news）启下（separate facts、better decisions），衔接自然。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：本段主题为提出好问题，写不轻信、问谁说的、有何证据、有无其他观点。B项"好奇心与健康的怀疑带来更清晰的理解"与ask questions、dig deeper、avoid being misled逻辑一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：段中写考虑多方视角、读不同来源、与不同经历者交流、扮演"魔鬼代言人"。C项"探索不同视角能强化你自己的判断"概括本段内容。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：段首点明注意自身偏见，后文写确认性偏见、自问为何同意、检查假设、乐于修正。D项"理解我们的心理捷径有助于我们更公正地思考"与段意相符。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段以[5]开头，后文建议从小事做起：质疑一则广告、核查一条标题、与朋友辩论一题。E项"培养这项技能从小而持续的练习开始"总领全段。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example...**：以For example开头，雇主看重批判性思维为单一案例，与任一段落的概括或承启功能不符，论述层次错位。